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# DYNAMIC INDUSTRIAL GOVERNANCE AND AFRICA'S SECOND LIBERATION

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The conversation about African industrialisation has fundamentally shifted. We are no longer asking if it will happen, but how it can be orchestrated to avoid the environmental and social failures of historical models. This demands a new industrial imagination — one that fuses governance, sustainability, and African agency with the transformative potential of digital and green technologies. Across Africa's industrial corridors, from Lesotho's textile workshops to Nairobi's solar panels, a quiet revolution is forming. It's not about factories; it's about freedom: the power to decide what gets built, who benefits, and who learns. Industrial policy, long dormant under neoliberal lethargy, is returning not as nostalgia but as necessity. Africa's next liberation is economic, coordinated, green, and digital.

This shift is called "green structural transformation": an economy designed not for extraction but for invention. Governance is not red tape; it is infrastructure for trust. African states can no longer be passive; they must steer technological transformation toward societal missions. Industrial policy becomes a dynamic, living strategy that harnesses AI, clean energy, and innovation, powered by institutions robust and agile enough to allow African nations to command their own economic destiny.

**Governance as a productive asset**

Every industrial miracle begins with governance that learns. Development is not control but coordination: states must listen, adapt, and act. This "possibilist" approach accepts that policy must be experimental, iterating and adapting to African institutional contexts. China offers a precedent: Special Economic Zones combined market forces with state guidance in constant trial and error.

Dynamic industrial governance is pragmatic, adaptive, and political. Africa does not need to mimic anyone; it must build its own experimental architecture. In Ethiopia's industrial parks, policy learning happens in real time. Similarly, Shenzhen began as controlled experimentation, proving policy can be a laboratory. Governance, when adaptive, becomes a production factor itself.